USER GUIDE · ADVISEPOINT DOCS

AdvisePoint Docs

User Guide

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A local search tool for technical manuals and admin guides.

Everything runs on your own laptop. No internet required after install.

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Chapter 1

System Requirements

Use the x64 package on Intel/AMD 64-bit Windows and the ARM64 package on Windows ARM64. Do not mix architectures. The runtime, database engine, document parsers and open-source PDF compatibility converter are bundled. No separate Node.js or PDF conversion browser is needed.

Allow about 500 MB for application files, plus space for the library, temporary processing and backups. Actual library size depends on the documents and any existing page images. Settings > System > Library storage shows the current breakdown; there is no fixed size multiplier. 4 GB RAM is a practical minimum; 8 GB or more is recommended for large documents. A laptop-size display is recommended.

The interface opens in the default browser at `http://127.0.0.1:5000`. Use a current Edge, Chrome or Firefox version. Document processing and search run locally. Internet access is needed for GitHub release checks and update downloads, not normal library use.

HELP — SIZING THE LIBRARY FOLDER

Uploaded documents live under %LOCALAPPDATA%\AdvisePoint Docs, not inside the app folder. If your system drive is tight, check Settings > System > Library storage for the actual size. Allow separate space for temporary processing and backups.

Chapter 2

Quick Start

1. Extract the complete ZIP into a writable local folder.
2. Keep the whole AdvisePoint Docs folder together. Do not run files from inside the ZIP.
3. Run **"Start AdvisePoint Docs.bat"**.
4. Open the Welcome Guide in the library, or use Upload to add files.

"Setup Icon (run once).bat" creates shortcuts if desired. Windows may warn about an unfamiliar downloaded launcher. Verify the package origin and checksum before deciding whether to allow it.

Closing the browser tab leaves the local service running. Background or suspended tabs do not trigger an automatic shutdown. Reopening the launcher reconnects to the existing service.

To stop intentionally, use Settings > System > Diagnostics > **"Stop application"**. Confirm only after finishing uploads, printing, external edits, backups and updates. Active tracked work blocks the stop. No library data is deleted. Scheduled backups pause while the service is stopped. Start the app again with its normal launcher.

> **TIP — PIN IT ONCE, LAUNCH IT FOREVER**
>
> After setup, right-click the AdvisePoint Docs shortcut and choose Pin to Taskbar. From then on the app is one click away, and the browser opens straight to the interface.

Chapter 3

Install Location

Keep the application in a writable local folder outside cloud-sync folders, network shares and Program Files. Keep its files together when moving it. Stop the service before moving application files.

Library data is stored separately under `%LOCALAPPDATA%\AdvisePoint Docs\`. Moving the application folder does not move or delete the library. Do not manually change the data directory while the service is running.

Chapter 4

Updating

Settings > System shows the installed version and update controls for official builds. **"Check now"** checks GitHub. An internet failure does not mean the local library is unavailable.

Use the offered update action to download the matching architecture. The updater validates the package before stopping the old service, replaces the application files, restarts and checks the new service. Keep the app folder writable and do not interrupt installation.

For a local package, use the ZIP update control in the same panel. Select the complete binary ZIP for the installed architecture, not the shared-source ZIP. Review the package information before confirming. Keep an independent library backup before an upgrade.

If an update fails, read the displayed message and export diagnostics. Do not delete the library to repair an update. A failed network check can be retried later without restarting the local service.

Chapter 5

Adding Documents

1. Open Upload and select or drop PDF, DOCX, RTF, TXT, MD or MARKDOWN files. The per-file limit is 150 MB.
2. Review the title, Product model, Product family and Document type. Product model is optional.
3. Add other useful metadata, then start the upload.

Folder selection and folder drag-and-drop include supported files in subfolders. Unsupported and oversized files appear in the summary; files are staged for review before import. Excel and PowerPoint are not supported import formats.

"Fix Title" suggests readable wording from the stored original filename. Review replacements for hand-edited titles. It also appears in Library metadata editing when an original filename is available. Filename-derived spacing avoids splitting ordinary words at DE. Unfamiliar names may still need manual adjustment.

Tags autocomplete from existing values. Filename codes and phrases suggest Document types without overwriting an explicit selection. After import, searchable excerpts and metadata are stored locally.

Reset at the right of Upload result clears completed result feedback. It does not remove imported documents, pending or failed staged files, or editable upload fields. It is unavailable during an active upload. New uploads show new results without refreshing the browser.

Chapter 6

Pdf Import and Printing

New normal PDFs retain one PDF and render pages on demand in the viewer, rather than permanently storing a page image for every page. Previously stored page images remain available; an upgrade does not automatically convert or delete existing library documents.

For supported PDFs that permit printing but restrict copying, the compatibility import uses the bundled open-source PDF converter. It does not launch Chrome, Edge or Firefox to convert a document. The converted PDF becomes the retained library copy; normal storage does not keep both the original PDF and its converted duplicate. Clickable links are preserved in the retained PDF where supported. Use an external PDF reader for those links; the in-app viewer does not add interactive links or bookmarks.

Compatibility is not universal. Damaged, unsupported or password- protected files may still fail. Review the result and import only documents that may lawfully be used. Do not assume every PDF is covered.

Use the viewer's print action to prepare the document. The app provides the appropriate PDF handoff or rendered-page preparation for the document. Complete printing in the browser or external reader that opens. External-reader copies are temporary and are not counted as active library storage.

Check page range, orientation, scaling and links before relying on a printout. Large jobs can take time to prepare. Physical printer behavior depends on the reader, printer and driver; broad physical printing validation remains pending.

Chapter 7

Searching and Viewing

Open Query, enter a question or phrase, and narrow the results with Product model, Product family, Document type, confidentiality or tags. Smart combines keyword and semantic matching. Phrase searches for an exact phrase; Semantic searches by meaning.

Product family normally includes documents with that family and those with no family recorded. Select **"Selected family only"** below the family list to exclude documents without the selected family. It is unchecked by default and unavailable while Family is Any. Product family and Product model remain independent filters. Strict searches with no matches are not automatically broadened.

Reset to the right of Search clears the search box, results and all filters, including Selected family only. Recent searches and library documents are preserved. Search mode and result-limit preferences stay unchanged. Recent searches and bookmarked search URLs restore the family-only option with the other search filters.

Select a result to open its source document. Use the page controls, scrollbar and zoom controls to navigate. In-document search helps locate text inside the open document.

On-demand PDF pages may show a loading message. Existing page-image documents remain viewable. A page retry control is available when an image cannot be loaded. Reader capabilities depend on the format and the text available in the document.

Chapter 8

Library Management

Library lists the imported documents. Edit metadata to change a title, product values, tags or other fields. Save commits the changes; Cancel leaves the stored metadata unchanged.

Deleting a library document removes it from the active library and keeps its retained recovery data according to the Recovery settings. Deletion is not a promise that every byte is immediately erased. Use Settings > Backup / Restore > Recovery to review retained items, restore them or explicitly delete them permanently.

Duplicate handling groups matching file hashes and allows a keeper to be selected. Review the affected documents before removing copies. Do not assume that similarly named documents are identical.

External editing is available for supported retained editable files. Save and finish the external editing session before stopping the app or installing an update. Do not remove working files manually.

Chapter 9

Settings

System:

- Installed version and updates.
- Library storage and viewer preferences.
- Library maintenance on the left and Diagnostics on the right on wide windows; stacked on narrow windows.
- Diagnostics includes export logs and Stop application.

Formats, in order:

- Document types, including per-type document usage counts.
- Manage Product Lists.
- Filename codes.
- Filename phrases.

Backup / Restore:

- Backup and restore controls.
- Recovery and pre-restore snapshots.
- Duplicates and interrupted or failed renders.
- Welcome Guide reinstall at the bottom.

Developer contains the metadata fields, filter mapping and examples.

Library storage refreshes about every 15 seconds while its panel is mounted and the page is active. It is not an instantaneous counter. Background browser throttling can delay refreshes. Reopening System resumes polling; no manual refresh or application restart is required.

The active total includes retained files, the database, SQLite working files and stored page images. Temporary external-reader copies, logs, backups and retained recovery data are not the active library total. SQLite files do not necessarily shrink immediately after documents are removed.

Chapter 10

Document Types and Product Lists

Settings > Formats > Document types supports renaming, recoloring, reordering, merging and deleting types, with usage counts. Deleting a type assigns its documents to the fallback Document type; merge instead to preserve a specific classification.

Manage Product Lists is directly below Document types. Its Product model and Product family lists come from values used by documents, not a separate empty-list registry. Each entry shows usage.

- Rename changes the value on affected documents.
- Merge combines an entry with an existing value.
- Delete reassigns the value or clears the field.

These changes keep the documents. Review the affected count and make a backup before bulk changes; there is no single-click undo.

Filename codes are matched before Filename phrases. Phrases run when no code matches. Both use the filename to suggest a Document type; an explicit selection is retained.

Chapter 11

Backup and Recovery

Settings > Backup / Restore offers Quick Backup, Scheduled Backups and Restore from Backup.

Quick Backup writes a library ZIP to the chosen folder. **"Download a copy"** sends a backup through the browser instead. Backups include the database, retained originals and stored page images.

Scheduled Backups allows a daily or weekly schedule. The local service must be running for the schedule to execute. Backups are full ZIPs, not incremental changes. Keep the destination writable with enough space for new files and verification.

"Keep a set number of backups" is the default mode. **"Backups to keep"** defaults to 7; existing saved counts are preserved. Each run creates a dated ZIP. Older matching archives are pruned only after at least one retained archive passes verification. Use a separate folder for manual master copies so ordinary count-based retention does not include them.

"Latest backup + previous backup" is optional. A new backup is written separately and verified before it becomes latest. The former valid latest becomes previous; a damaged latest does not replace a valid previous. Creation or verification failure leaves existing recovery copies available. If neither existing copy verifies, review the files or select another destination before retrying.

The pair is stored inside **"AdvisePoint-Scheduled-Pair"** in the selected folder. Settings lists each copy's timestamp and filename; select the appropriate ZIP when restoring. Do not edit pair-state.json. The first successful run creates latest; previous appears after the second. Switching modes preserves the saved count and does not immediately delete existing dated archives. Pair mode does not remove manual files or historical count-based backups. A later count-mode run still applies normal count retention to matching files in the selected parent folder.

Pair mode normally retains two full copies, but needs extra temporary space for a new archive and verification. Interrupted runs or cleanup failures may temporarily leave additional owned files; cleanup retries after a successful backup. No backup is deleted early to make room. This is not a permanent master copy or long-term version history. Keep an independent backup on another drive for additional protection.

Restore offers two modes:

- Merge adds documents not already present by document ID.
- Wipe replaces the live library, requires typed confirmation and keeps a pre-restore snapshot.

Restore stages and verifies the incoming backup before replacement. Keep an independent backup and do not interrupt the operation. Pre-restore snapshots are listed under Recovery and kept beside the data directory. Manual snapshot recovery requires the service to be stopped. A retained snapshot can help recover the previous state, but it is not a substitute for an independent backup.

Recovery also lists removed documents. Review retention and any optional automatic cleanup settings before enabling them. Permanent deletion frees recovery storage and cannot be undone by that panel.

At the bottom of Backup / Restore, **"Reinstall Welcome Guide"** restores the bundled guide to the library. Use it after updating when a fresh copy of the guide is needed.

> **WARNING — A WIPE RESTORE REPLACES YOUR LIBRARY**
>
> Choose Merge if you want to add documents from a backup without changing what's already in the library. Every wipe restore keeps a pre-restore snapshot next to your data folder, so a mistake is recoverable while that snapshot remains intact. Keep an independent backup and stop the service before manual recovery.

Chapter 12

Data and Troubleshooting

The normal data folder is `%LOCALAPPDATA%\AdvisePoint Docs\`. It contains `advisepoint.db`, originals, pages, recovery data and logs. The data folder survives application updates and reinstallation. Do not delete or reset it as a routine troubleshooting step.

If the interface cannot connect, wait briefly if an update is running, then try the normal launcher. A connection warning does not establish whether the cause is a crash, restart or other interruption.

Settings > System > Diagnostics > **"Export logs for analysis"** downloads a diagnostic ZIP. It includes current and previous server logs, update and backup records when available, and system information. It excludes the library database and document contents, but logs can contain filenames and local paths. Review the bundle before sharing. Export promptly after a fault, before repeated restarts rotate logs.

If GitHub cannot be reached but Query and Library still work, retry the update check later. This is separate from local-service health. Do not clear library data or change security settings to repair a network failure.

Chapter 13

Glossary

Backup

A timestamped ZIP containing the SQLite database, rendered page images, and original uploaded files — everything needed to restore the library on the same machine or a different one.

Chunk

A short searchable excerpt of a document, produced by the indexer at upload time. Search results return matching chunks with their parent document.

Confidentiality Ceiling

A per-document setting (public / internal / restricted) that lets you exclude higher-sensitivity documents from a search using the "Show up to" filter.

Dist.bak

A copy of the previous application build kept next to the new one after an update. If the swap fails, the updater restores it automatically. Superseded on the next successful update.

Document Type

A metadata category applied at upload time (Service Guide, Admin Guide, Release Notes, etc.). Used for filtering searches. Names are stored in Title Case, and the list is editable in Settings > Formats > Document types.

Keeper

In duplicate handling, the document chosen to remain in the library while the other copies are moved to quarantine.

Match Mode

The strategy used to rank a query: Smart (default hybrid), Phrase (exact-phrase), or Semantic (meaning-only).

Merge Restore

A restore mode that adds documents from a backup that are not already in the library. Existing documents with the same id are skipped, never overwritten.

Pre-Restore Snapshot

A copy of the live data directory saved automatically before a wipe restore, under `%LOCALAPPDATA%\AdvisePoint Docs.bak-<timestamp>\`. You can restore from it manually with the app closed.

Product Family

The top-level product line a document belongs to (e.g. "AdvisePoint", "MZ Series"). Independent from Product model — the two filters do not narrow each other.

Product Model

The specific product a document describes (e.g. "MZ9500ci"). Optional at upload time; useful for filtering search results.

Quarantine

The `deleted\` folder under the data directory where removed documents are stored non-destructively until you Restore them or delete them permanently.

Recovery Panel

The Settings > Backup / Restore > Recovery view listing retained documents and pre-restore snapshots, with per-item Restore and Delete actions and an opt-in auto-cleanup toggle for duplicates.

Sha-256

A cryptographic hash the app computes over every uploaded file and every backup ZIP. Used to detect duplicate uploads and to verify a backup before restoring from it.

Smartscreen

The Windows security prompt ("Windows protected your PC") shown for files marked as downloaded from the internet. Both AdvisePoint launcher batch files strip that mark from the folder on first run so subsequent launches are silent.

Stage-Verify-Swap

The safety pattern used by the updater and by restore: the new content is unpacked into a staging directory, verified end-to-end, and only then swapped in. If verification fails, nothing is replaced.

Wipe Restore

A restore mode that replaces the entire live library with the backup contents. Requires typed confirmation and creates a pre-restore snapshot.

Chapter 14

Index of Common Tasks

Quick jumping-off points for the things people ask about most often. Each entry points to the chapter that covers it in full.

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Colophon

This is the User Guide for AdvisePoint Docs version 1.3.3, document revision 1.3.3, dated September 28, 2026. It ships inside the application as a seeded welcome document so a fresh install has something to search and read on day one. Body text is set in Times Roman; headings and callouts in Helvetica. The guide is generated from `packaging/README.txt` at build time — the source-of-truth for what the application does.

For diagnosis, use Settings > System > Diagnostics. Update controls are in Settings > System.